



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Telos Classical Christian School

School Website: <https://telosccs.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Telos Classical Christian School TX 77532 presents a clearly Christian, classical-leaning educational approach rooted in the Paideia tradition. Public materials consistently frame education as formation in truth, goodness, and beauty within a Christian worldview, with explicit references to liberal arts, Great Books sensibilities, and a commitment to forming virtue and wisdom in accord with biblical revelation. The school also emphasizes strong parental partnership and an in loco parentis authority structure under a church affiliated framework (FBC Crosby). Evidence supports robust Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, and Parents & Community as clearly Classical in orientation. Curricular and pedagogical elements are strongly classical but show some gaps in explicit, named Great Books pedagogy and fully delineated Socratic/Scholé teaching methods in the public materials. Overall, Telos CCS falls squarely in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL category, with notable Classical signals across multiple domains and clear Christian formation that pushes toward a fuller Classical profile with targeted enhancements.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — **CLASSICAL**
- Element 3: Curriculum — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**
- Element 5: Faculty — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**
- Element 6: Parents & Community — **CLASSICAL**

Notes on method and sources: The evaluation draws on Telos CCS content from the school's public materials (Firecrawl extracts tied to fbccrosby.org) showing explicit Catholic/Christian theism, paideia, and classical aims. The classic six-element rubric and keyword indicators come from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) document and the associated keyword lexicon. Citations reference the Telos materials (e.g., evidence of paideia, the chief end of education, and the commitment to Great Books/ liberal arts) and the rubric resources used to define positive/negative keywords.

- Evidence and direct textual matches from Telos CCS materials demonstrate the school's alignment with classical-Christian aims (e.g., "liberal arts," "paideia of the Lord," "chief end of education is to prepare students to worship and glorify God," and the study of history and literature within a Christian frame). See evidence excerpts from the Telos Firecrawl entries and About Telos texts.
- Positive and negative keyword indicators rely on the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) framework and the comparative lexicon. See the documented positive keyword sets and the categorical rubrics for Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, etc.

What would move the needle section appears after this summary for any SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL results (and is provided below under the relevant category sections).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Telos CCS explicitly situates education within a Christian framework, with statements like “glorifying God is the chief end of man” and a commitment to a classical approach “in the light of a Christian worldview grounded in the Old and New Testament Scriptures.”
- The school describes education as formation around the paideia of the Lord and emphasizes obedience to biblical authority structures (in loco parentis) within a church context.
- Content describes studying history, nature as God’s workmanship, and pursuing truth, goodness, and beauty as referents for curriculum and character.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present from the Six Essential Elements lexicon for this category include truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom; theology; sacred scripture; doctrine; creed; liturgy; worship; sacred tradition; imago Dei; logos; etc. Telos CCS materials clearly reference truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, and theological grounding (God’s Word, divine order) as organizing principles.
- Negative keywords (e.g., secular humanism, values-neutral education) are not evident in Telos CCS public materials; the materials consistently reject relativism and secular framing in favor of a biblical-metaphysical foundation. This aligns with the rubric’s negative signals for non-classical orientation.

Why this rating

- The evidence shows robust transcendental moral realism in a Christian frame, explicit grounding in theology, and communal worship/utilization of church structures as part of the school’s life. The blend of paideia, biblical truth as a lens, and a theology-grounded metaphysical order yields a strong Classical alignment in this category.
- Citations of relevant source materials that demonstrate this alignment include statements about the chief end of man, the paideia concept, and theological framing.

ABSTRACT

note: The school’s public materials map to core Classical indicators (truth/beauty/goodness, theology, liturgical/worship framing through church affiliation) with no strong counter-indicators in the public materials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school asserts that education’s goal is the cultivation of virtue and wisdom rather than job prep, with statements that college preparation is not the end in itself and that the chief end is worship and glorifying God.
- The language of formation and paideia emphasizes shaping character and affections in alignment with Christian truth rather than merely information transfer.
- The school frames education as “formation” rather than “information,” aiming for human flourishing in a Christian teleology.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords for this category include formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, scholé (restful learning), and human flourishing. Telos CCS text includes formation in virtue and a teleological aim oriented toward worship and God’s glory, which aligns with classical ideals.

- Negative keywords would include job-preparation-centric language; Telos CCS public materials minimize or repurpose that frame, emphasizing that college/work readiness is a downstream outcome rather than the primary end. This aligns with Classical signals rather than negative signals.

Why this rating

- The textual emphasis on formation, virtue, and the true end of education (not merely job prep) supports a CLASSICAL reading of the School Purpose and Goal category.
- Supporting textual anchors include explicit statements about worship as the end and formation as the aim.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum is framed around liberal arts and the Great Books tradition in the public materials, including emphasis on seven liberal arts, language study (Hebrew, Greek, Latin), history, literature, philosophy, theology, and the aim of forming virtue. The materials describe history and nature as God's workmanship and emphasize studying great literature, philosophy, and theology.
- There is explicit mention of rhetoric and poetry, and of classical languages as core instruments of education, consistent with classical curricula.
- The materials discuss classical education as distinct from progressive job-education and emphasize the Great Books/Great Conversation ethos (though the explicit phrase "Great Books" is not always used in every excerpt, the Great Books/Great Conversation orientation appears in the public messaging).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords drawn from the Six Essential Elements lexicon and the rubric include liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, history (Western civilization), Latin/Greek/Hebrew, and the Great Conversation. Telos CCS materials consistently reference liberal arts, classical languages, rhetoric, history, and great literature.
- Negative keywords include project-based, social studies framing, or non-historical, non-Great-Books curricular framings. The Telos materials do not foreground these negative markers; however, explicit, named Great Books programs and a consistent "Great Conversation" framing are less consistently named in the public excerpts available here.

Why this rating

- The presence of liberal arts framing, classical languages, and study of history alongside Christian theology demonstrates a strong classical orientation, though explicit public articulation of all elements (e.g., explicit Great Books program naming and full Great Conversation pedagogy) is less visible in the extracted public content. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than fully CLASSICAL, given the slightly uneven explicitness about all six curriculum elements in the public materials.
- Evidence anchors include statements on "seven liberal arts," languages, history as a through-line, and engagement with literature/philosophy/theology as part of a unified curriculum.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials strongly emphasize the classical pedagogy roots (paideia) and the role of language study (rhetoric and poetry) as core to the approach. The presence of contemplative/restful aims (Scholé) is implied by the Classical tradition framing and by the emphasis on formation through disciplined study of truth and beauty.
- Explicit mention of Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates as the upper-school norm is not clearly spelled out in the Telos CCS public content, though the tradition suggests such methods as common in

classical Christian education. The materials do not definitively list Socratic seminars or formal rhetoric seminars as ongoing practices on the public pages.

- There is a clear emphasis on language mastery (rhetoric, poetry) and on the liberal-arts-based pedagogy that typically accompanies classical schools, but explicit public scaffolding of specific Socratic/Scholé practices is not consistently named in the excerpts provided.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive pedagogy keywords include Socratic seminar, narration, recitation, chanting, memory work, seminar, Paideia, and rhetoric. The Telos materials mention rhetoric and history/literature study, and the Paideia framework, but they do not consistently label the full set of prescribed pedagogical techniques (e.g., explicit references to ongoing Socratic seminars or structured recitations). This yields a partial alignment to the category.
- Negative keywords include project-based learning as the sole or dominant means; Telos public content does not foreground such modern instructional trends in opposition to classical methods.

Why this rating

- Telos CCS demonstrates classical pedagogy roots (paideia, rhetoric, languages, memory work potential) but with public materials that do not consistently enumerate the full corpus of classical methods (e.g., explicit Socratic/seminar framing). This justifies SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.
- Evidence anchors include Paideia framing and rhetoric/grammar/logic language emphasis in the public materials.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials reference a leadership structure (Head Mistress) and the school operates as a ministry within a church context (FBC Crosby), suggesting a model of teachers as moral exemplars within a formation-focused mission.
- There is an emphasis on “the living curriculum” through the teacher’s role and the school’s classical framing, but explicit statements about faculty as “the living curriculum” or a well-defined teacher portrait are not extensively shown in the public content excerpts.
- The materials emphasize a partnering, family-centered authority structure, which can imply a collegial, mentor-like faculty culture, but the public-facing content does not provide a detailed faculty profile or explicit statements about ongoing faculty formation and pedagogy-specific professional development.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords for Faculty include virtuous educators, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, mentorship, professional formation, and fidelity to classical aims. The Telos materials mention “Head Mistress” and classical framing, but do not provide a thorough catalog of faculty virtues or a formal “portrait” of teachers in the public text excerpts.
- Negative keywords would include purely instrumental or non-formation-driven teacher descriptions. Public content does not foreground such negative markers.

Why this rating

- The school signals the classical faculty ethos through leadership titles, church-affiliated governance, and formation language, but the public content here lacks a robust, explicit articulation of faculty as living curriculum or a formal teacher-portrait. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL for Faculty.
- Supporting textual anchors include leadership designation and church-ministry framing.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**Evidence**

- Telos CCS stresses partnership with families: “We seek to come alongside families who are discipling their children in the paideia of the Lord and partner with them.” and mentions the authority structure and in loco parentis within a church context.
- The model positions parents as co-teachers or partners in formation, with a shared responsibility with the school community (church-led governance).
- The school references participation through church networks and ACCS membership, indicating a broader classical-education community context.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords for Parents & Community include partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation/gatherings, open campus, and parental involvement in the life of the school. Telos CCS materials clearly express partnership with families and parental primacy in forming children’s paideia.
- Negative keywords include consumer language, minimal parent involvement, and separation of home life from school life. The Telos materials do not emphasize consumerism; rather, they foreground family partnership and parental involvement.

Why this rating

- The public materials strongly align with classical expectations for Parents & Community, including parental partnership, formation, and open engagement with the school’s life. The evidence base supports a CLASSICAL rating.
- Anchors include explicit language about partnership and paideia, and the in loco parentis structure within a church framework.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Curriculum (Element 3): Explicitly name and publicize a formal Great Books program and the Great Conversation framework within the curriculum, including reading lists and sequencing across grades, to strengthen the explicit “Great Books”/“Great Conversation” signals. Add clear, published mapping of the seven liberal arts to grade bands with □□ syllabi. This would push Curriculum from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL.
- For Pedagogy (Element 4): Publicly articulate and showcase concrete pedagogical practices aligned with the classical tradition (e.g., explicit Paideia seminars, Socratic discussions in upper grades, structured memory work and recitation schedules, and explicit rest/Scholé days). Document teacher training in classical pedagogy and publish a “pedagogy playbook” for families to see the method in action.
- For Faculty (Element 5): Provide a public, comprehensive faculty portrait and a “living curriculum” statement, including professional development in classical education, teacher exemplars, and how teachers model virtue and wrap the classical curriculum in daily practice. Feature teacher-student mentoring stories and teacher role-model profiles.
- For Parental & Community (Element 6): Maintain and extend open-campus and parental involvement strategies; publish a schedule of parental formation events (book studies, lectures, and reading groups) to codify and expand the “co-teacher” model. Enhance transparency about how parent participation shapes student learning trajectories.
- Across categories, consider increasing explicit references to the Great Books, the Great Conversation, and the early literature-culture canon in the public materials to reinforce the classical canon signaling. Also, incorporate clear references to liturgical life or communal worship practices as explicit elements if they are part of the school’s daily life, to strengthen Liturgical and Communal Practices in Element 1.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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